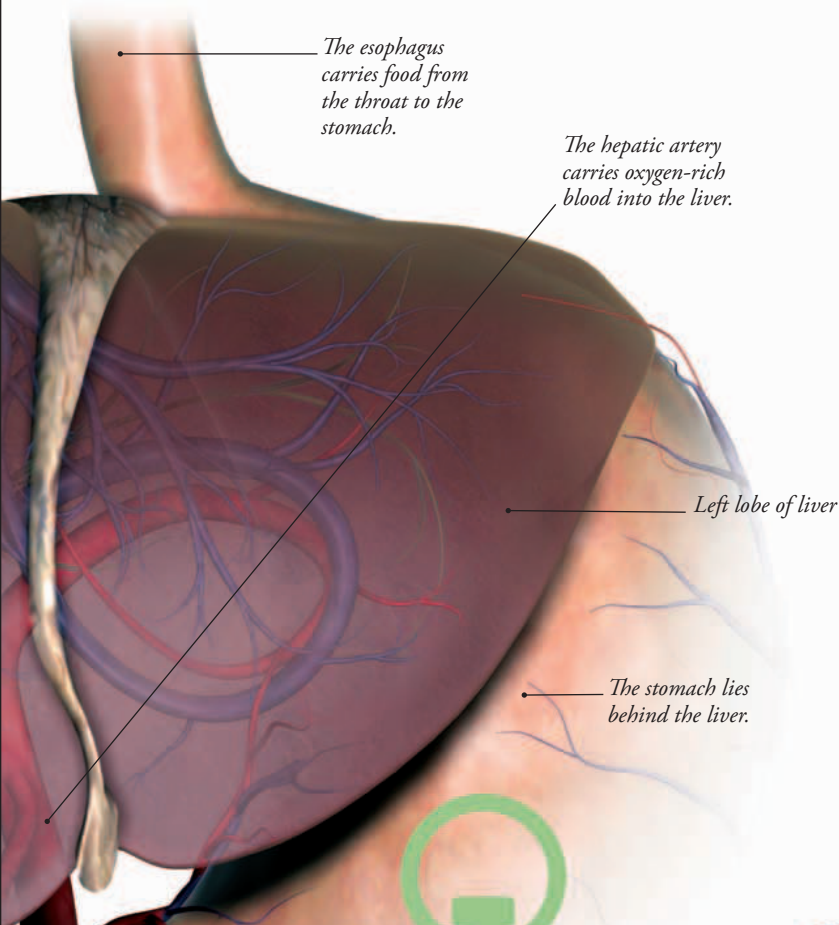




BLOOD SUPPLY

The liver has two blood supplies. The hepatic artery delivers oxygen-rich blood from your heart. The hepatic portal vein carries blood from your digestive organs and supplies 80 percent of the liver's blood. Nutrients and other substances in the blood are processed by the liver.

Large intestine

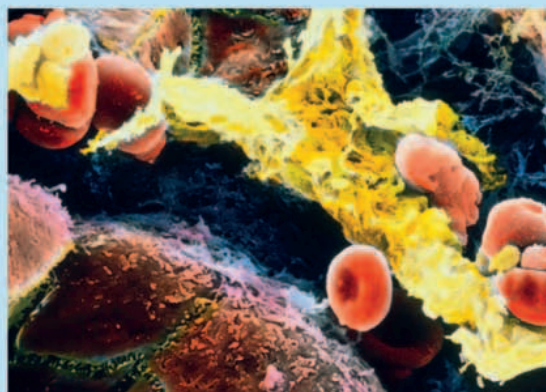
► HEPATIC PORTAL VEIN

Veins from many parts of the digestive system, including the stomach and intestines, join together to form the hepatic portal vein, which takes nutrient-rich blood to the liver.



LOOK CLOSER: BLOOD CLEANERS

The small blood vessels that pass between liver cells are lined with macrophages (cells that eat other cells) called Kupffer cells. They “clean” blood by removing worn-out red blood cells, along with bacteria and debris. The iron retrieved from red blood cells is recycled.



▲ **KUPFFER CELLS** *This incredible magnified image shows a Kupffer cell (yellow) trapping and consuming old red blood cells (red).*

